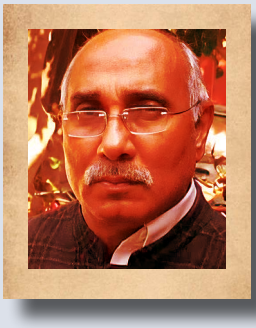
GANGLORDS OF THE WILD WEST

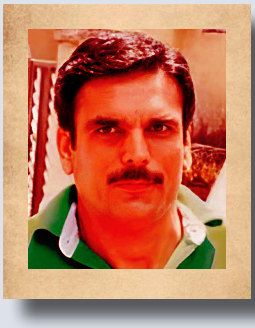


SUSHIL MOONCH

Areas of operation: **Meerut, Muzaffarnagar**

No. of cases: **49**

Known variously as Sushil Moonch, Langda and Pradhanji, he runs a gang called IAS99. Starting out with a cable operator business, Moonch was running an organised racket of hired hitmen. Accused of murder, robbery and extortion, the 49 cases registered against him include more than 10 cases of murder in the Meerut and Muzaffarnagar districts. He was going out for a movie with a young girl when he was first arrested for murder in 2012. He was let out on bail in 2017 and was on the run till 2019, when he surrendered before the Muzaffarnagar court because he feared he would be killed in an encounter. He remains lodged in Ambedkarnagar jail currently.



UDHAM SINGH

Area of operation: **Meerut**

No. of cases: **70**

A resident of Karnawal village in Meerut, Udham Singh has been out to settle scores with Moonch ever since he allegedly had his henchman Manoj Rana killed in the Civil Lines area of Bijnor in 2016. When he openly threatened to eliminate Moonch in 2018, an FIR was lodged against Singh at Bijnor police station under Section 506 (punishment for criminal intimidation) of the IPC. He was finally arrested by the UP police in 2021 when he threatened bank employees in Meerut. He is currently lodged in Unnao jail from where he continued to run his racket successfully till the police started cracking down on his gang and activities. More than 30 members of his gang have been arrested and several of his properties seized.



BADAN SINGH BADDO

Area of operation: **Meerut**

No. of cases: **43**

The 48-year-old is the more flashy of the UP dons, dressed in trousers, shirt and blazer with a matching pocket square. His flashiness, though, does not end at his attire. In 2019, in Bollywood-esque fashion, Baddo made a daring escape after allegedly entertaining the police team with him at a hotel where alcohol was served.

Currently, there is a Red Corner Notice (RCN) out against Baddo, who is believed to have fled the country. He is said to own businesses in Australia where his estranged wife and daughter live, though the police deny their link to Baddo. He was sentenced to life imprisonment in 2017 for the murder of lawyer Ravinder Singh in 1996. The police claim they have destroyed his entire crime nexus.



HAJI YAQOOB QURESHI

Area of operation: **Meerut**

No. of cases: **16**

Haji Yaqoob Qureshi, a former BSP MLA, is allegedly involved in cattle smuggling. The Special Task Force (STF) of the UP Police arrested him and his elder son Imran in January for running an illegal meat packaging plant. The duo had been absconding since last year after a case against them and 12 others was registered under various sections of the IPC, including 420 (cheating) and 120 B (criminal conspiracy), for running a meat plant without a licence. The police booked them under the Gangsters Act. Qureshi had announced a Rs 51 crore bounty on the head of Danish cartoonist Kurt Westergaard in 2006 for caricaturing the Prophet and a reward of a similar amount to the *Charlie Hebdo* attackers in 2015.